

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair
Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



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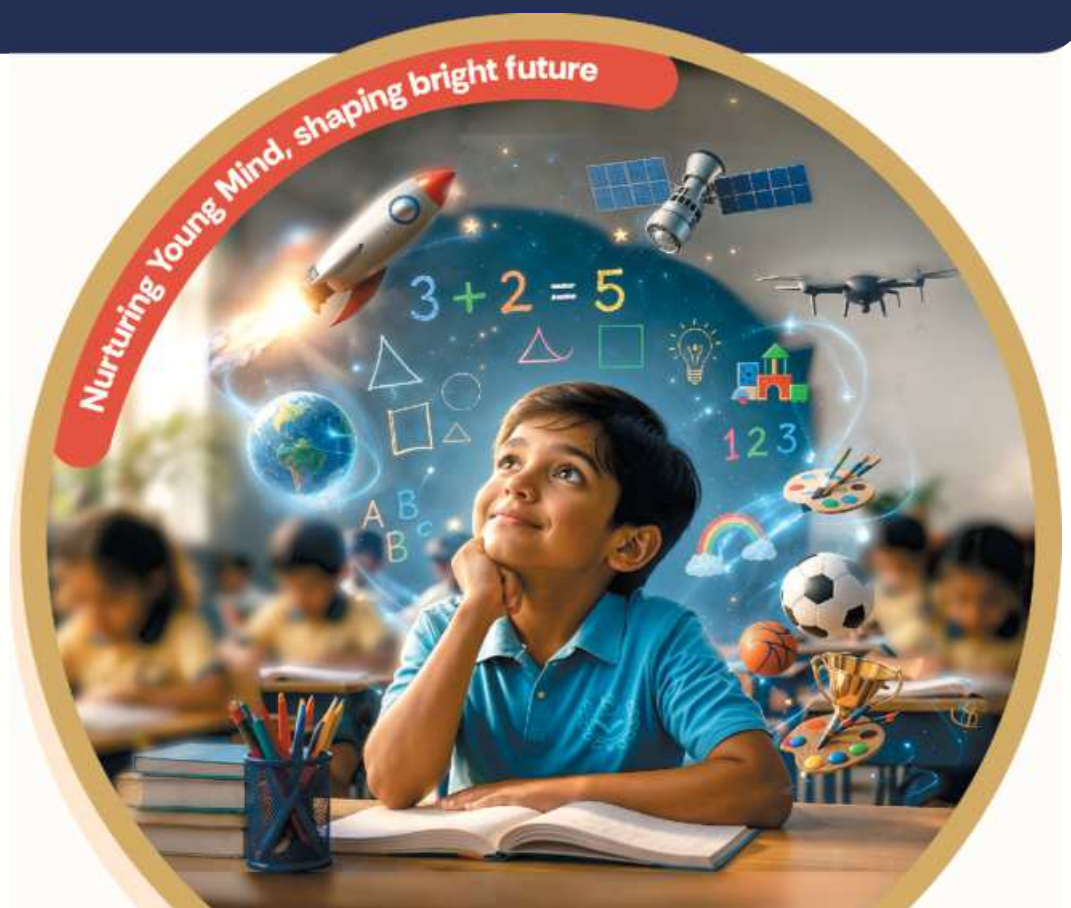
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T. SADAGOPAN

In 2008, it was announced that the Tamil Nadu Water Supply & Drainage Board would provide piped drinking water supply and an underground sewage system for Avadi in Avadi Assembly Constituency.

Later, around 2015, Avadi was selected under the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation & Urban Transformation (AMRUT), another scheme aimed at providing water supply and sewage infrastructure. However, Avadi still lacks both the facilities. Work has begun only in a few places. Similarly, an underground electricity cable network was announced many years ago, but only TNHB Colony has received this facility. Residents in other parts of Avadi continue to wait for it. Avadi was upgraded from a Special Grade Municipality to a Corporation in 2019. However, the change has largely remained on paper. The status boost has made no difference, except for higher taxes. Even an online grievance redressal system has not been enabled on the Avadi Corporation website, though an online facility for tax payment is available.

A flyover was planned from HVF

An unkept promise

With the Assembly elections at the door, Tamil Nadu Progressive Consumer Centre has flagged long-pending development projects in Avadi



Heaps of solid waste clogging a drain at the junction of HVF Road and CTH Road in Avadi. The image was taken on May 2025.

PHOTO: VEDHAN . M

Road junction on CTH Road to Kamaraj Nagar junction on New Military Road. A subway was also proposed to connect Avadi railway station and Avadi bus terminus. However, neither proposal has seen progress.

Avadi has several waterbodies including Thandurai Lake, Vizhinjambakkam Lake, Sitheri Lake, Kovilpathagai Lake and Nemilichery Lake. We have been requesting elected representatives to restore these waterbodies, but our efforts have been in vain. During heavy rains, water overflows from these lakes, flooding roads and the railway station.

We have also been urging elected representatives to ensure that more express trains halt at Avadi railway station, which would spare residents the inconvenience of travelling to and from Chennai Central. However, only a few express trains currently stop here.

The association has also called for the creation of a railway station near the IT Park in Pattabiram, which was inaugurated in November 2024.

T. Sadagopan is the President of the Tamil Nadu Progressive Consumer Centre, a citizens' group based in Avadi

RWAs in Ambattur draw up a list of demands

United Welfare Associations - Ambattur, a federation of residents associations of Ambattur, organised a meet last week to compile a list of demands to be presented to the elected MLA of Ambattur Assembly Constituency. Around 20 associations affiliated to the federation took part in it.

Unsafe roads, pollution of waterbodies, poor water supply, and encroachments, were among the various issues that were discussed at the meet.

East Balaji Nagar People Welfare Association raised the issue of parking of vehicles along the Patravakkam section of service road of Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass.

"The service road that is from Patravakkam Railway Station to T4 Pudur Police Station is lined with mechanic shops and they encroach upon the road space to park their customers' vehicles," says T.R. Ilayakumar, president, East Balaji Nagar People Welfare Association.

East Balaji Nagar People Welfare Association brought up the encroachment of a park in their neighbourhood.

"Greater Chennai Corporation is pursuing this issue legally. The association on its part is helping the GCC by providing the necessary documents that will stand scrutiny in the eyes of the law. We want the



The service road near Patravakkam and sewage overflowing at a street in Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar.

PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

newly elected MLA to pay attention to this issue and ensure a park is developed," adds Ilayakumar.

Vivek Nagar People Welfare Society wants better water supply.

"Water supply is poor due to low pressure. Our colony is situated at the tail end of the water supply line and therefore the pressure is low. There is an overhead water tank at Vivek Nagar but no water is supplied from this tank to residents of Vivek Nagar. It may be noted the OSR land where the overhead tank is located was meant for a park. Many years ago, the association allowed it for overhead water tank construction. And now we neither have the park nor water," says R. Sathiyavel, secretary, Vivek Nagar



People Welfare Society.

Bharat Ratna Rajiv Gandhi Nagar Residents Welfare Association raised the issue of encroachments of two waterbodies: Vannankulam and Sunnambukulam.

The association wants the en-

croachments to be removed and the waterbodies restored and a park developed around them. It also drew attention to the unauthorised extraction of groundwater for commercial purposes.

Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar

Residents Welfare Association sees the need for underground sewage drain system.

"For the past 15 years the association is pursuing this issue but elected representatives have been citing fund crunch. Due to the absence of this facility sewage overflowing onto the roads is a common sight here," says C.H. Balaji, the association's secretary.

Lenin Nagar residents highlighted the issue of sewage discharge into stormwater drains.

T. Chokkalingam, vice-president of Thiruvengada Nagar Residents Welfare Association, wanted relaying of First Main Road and West End Road in Thiruvengada Nagar. Both are main roads and they were last relaid a decade ago.

During the meet, R. Ramalingam, joint secretary of the federation, highlighted the need for an increase in the number of primary health centres and resident B.V. Ramadoss pointed out the need for high-secondary section in government schools in Ambattur as the existing government schools have up to class 10 only.

Another major issue that was discussed during the meeting was reduction in property tax.

"Residents of Ambattur Zone are paying higher property tax to Greater Chennai Corporation than Adyar and Teynampet Zones where neighbourhoods like Boat Club, Poes Garden, and Besant Nagar are located," says S. Suresh, the federation's president.

For a copy of Voter ID

If your name is on the electoral roll and your mobile number is registered with the Election Commission of India and linked to your EPIC, you can download a copy of your voter ID online from <https://voters.eci.gov.in>

For quick assistance

Voter helpline numbers

1950/ 1800 425 0424

Official website

www.elections.tn.gov.in

What to take to the booth

* Obviously, the Voter Identification Card

* If you are on the electoral roll, your number registered with ECI, but do not have the Voter ID Card at present, it would help to carry any of these documents with you: Aadhaar Card, PAN card, Indian Passport, Driving Licence or Pension Documents

Need support on *election day?*

Inclusive vehicle to take voters to polling booth

Vidya Sagar, an NGO working for persons with disabilities, has procured an additional vehicle as part of its 'Get Going' initiative that helps those with disabilities travel comfortably in an inclusive vehicle. As in previous years, two of these vehicles will be pressed into service for senior citizens and PwDs wanting to reach the polling booth without any hassle.

The vehicle is equipped with a hydraulic lift and can accommodate up to three wheelchairs with four addi-

tional seats. There are specially trained support staff to meet the needs of the special-needs people.

The NGO charges a fee based on distance between the home and polling booth for ferrying

the voter. During other times of the year, these vehicles are used to take students on a field trips. **The vehicle has to be booked at least a day in advance. For bookings, call 9444398182.**

**Help at the polling station**

If you know someone who would need a wheelchair or a sign language interpreter at the polling booth then ask them to download the Election Commission of India's Saksham App. This tool for persons with disabilities allows them to participate in the electoral process with some degree of ease. It offers them a number of features including how to find their polling station.

The mobile application is currently making sure there is wheelchair support at the polling booth, Indian Sign Language Interpreter and help to deal

with other concerns. The App requires one to place a request in advance so that a volunteer can be arranged on polling day.



A sign language interpreter working with the team says they have close to 15 interpreters and the requests placed on the App are by individuals as well as associations working for PwDs.

In the 2024 Lok Sabha Elections, most polling stations only had a booth where one could reach out for any assistance. A sign language interpreter says, "Through a video call made from the stall, we were assisting the deaf and the mute. This time, the plan is to have both."

Special buses

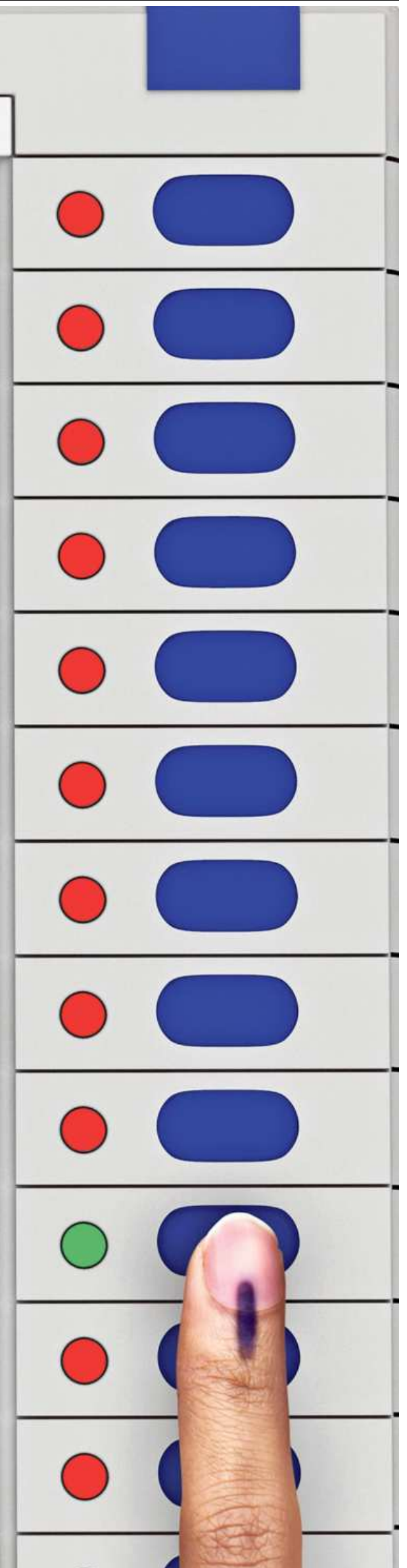
Tamil Nadu State Transport Corporation will ply special long-distance buses from April 21 to 23 to enable people to get their polling booth without much difficulty.

From Kalaingar Centenary Bus Terminus (KCBT) in Kilambak-

kam, buses will operate to Pudukcherry, Cuddalore, Chidambaram, Trichy, Madurai, Tuticorin and Coimbatore. At Koyambedu, find buses going to East Coast Road, Vellore, Thiruttani and Bengaluru. From Madhavaram New Bus Stand, there are buses to Andhra Pradesh via Ponneri,

Gummidipoondi, and to Trichy, Salem, Kumbakonam, and Thiruvannamalai. The public can book tickets online through www.tnsrc.in and on the official Tamil Nadu State Transport Corporation app.

To learn more about bus routes, call 94450 14436.



When a stool makes a huge difference at the polling booth

Members of Tamil Nadu Dwarfism Association have reiterated a set of demands, one they always make when it is time to head to the hustings

LIFFY THOMAS

Every election, when Dayanand walks into the polling booth at Ranipet in Vellore, he has a prayer on his lips. He needs a prop to be able to vote comfortably and correctly. He needs a stool. Standing just two feet tall, the 28-year-old struggles to press the right button on the electronic voting machine when there is no stool for him to stand on.

Dayanand has been contemplating seeking the 'vote from home' option.

A stool at the polling booth is a unique need faced by those with dwarfism, one of the 21 disabilities in the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016.

Every election, they make this need felt ahead of the visit to the hustings.

At three-and-a-half feet, M.G. Rakul is at a slight advantage. "But I strain to get hold of the right button I want to press," says the Ekkaduthangal resident. Many a time, he has pressed the button on the bottom of the EVM list where his fingers would reach first, unwittingly voting for a political party whose position he does not endorse.

Most people with dwarfism hate to be carried and such experiences at the polling booth leave them with an unpleasant feeling. In the recently concluded Assembly elections in Kerala, there are reports about a dwarf voter in Thiruvananthapuram who brought his personal stool so that he can vote at ease.

Assistance at booth

Tamil Nadu Dwarfism Association has made two other requests to the Election Commission. They want a separate line for persons with disabilities at polling stations and volunteers to assist them till the end when the distance from the drop-off point and polling booth is far.

Despite their request not being met, the community is clear they want to vote and will nudge all others with a valid voting identity card to participate in the process. "There are more than 500 people with dwarfism in Tamil Nadu, and at least 100 in Chennai," says R. Gopinath, who heads the Tamil Nadu Dwarfism Association.

The Association has sent reminders to all members to exercise their vote. Says Rakul: "This time, we are even asking our members to use the Saksham App and request for a volunteer in advance at the polling booth, but downloading the app and making a request is not easy for many of us."



A model volunteer at May Day Park

A Chintadripet resident takes enormous efforts to create a sense of community at this famous green space

R. RAGU

M. Dhulath Sah is an unpaid staffer at May Day Park in Chintadripet, volunteering to enhance the park-going experience for visitors. He conducts yoga classes for anyone who cares to enrol for it, trains children in badminton, all of them done *pro bono*. On special occasions, notable among them being Independence Day, Pongal and Republic Day,



M. Dhulath Sah leading a yoga session at the park. PHOTO: R. RAGU

he decorates the park, the effort fuelled by money volunteered by visitors. From time to time, he also conducts sports and cultural events for children, which culminate in a prize-giving ceremony. A resident of Ayya Street, 59-year-old Dhulath was running a two-wheeler spare

parts shop, which he had shut down permanently due to the pandemic. His home is being run by the salary brought home by his elder son, 24-year-old Rahul Sah who pursues CA and works at a consultancy firm in his spare time. His other son, Prasanth Sah is studying B.Pharm.

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'View of traffic signal in Kilpauk obstructed'



The traffic signal at the intersection of Kilpauk Garden Road and Taylors Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ANOSH NISHTER SADAT

The traffic signal at the intersection of Kilpauk Garden Road and Taylors Road (opposite Bhan's School) is in fine fettle, working as it has to.

However, a month ago another signal post was installed in front of the one which is functioning. This

new post (which is part of an intelligent traffic management system) has not been set in operation to this day. But, it obstructs the view the traffic signal post behind it, the one functioning, especially for motorists who wait in the first two rows. This causes confusion.

Anosh Nishter Sadat is a resident of Perambur

Ticket counter shifted to new building at Ambattur railway station

T. GUNASEELAN

It is a month since the ticket counter at Ambattur railway station was shifted to a new building that was constructed as part of Amrit Bharat Scheme. The new facility is quite spacious. Further, the new ticket counter is located at the entrance of the station which is quite convenient. Earlier, it was located in the middle of platform one which was not convenient for commuters who had to go to platform two.

Likewise, the station master's office and the ticket examiner's office are also now housed in a new building constructed in the place of the razed-down old building. Further, truss work is under way at the GNG Street entrance of the station in Varadharajapuram. Work is progressing at a brisk pace at the station.

T. Gunaseelan is a resident of Ambattur



The ticket counter; and (below) the truss work at the entrance at Ambattur railway station.

You can be our volunteer writer



Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.

'Wrong time to start the water pipe laying work'

P. ARUNKUMAR

Citing the Model Code Conduct of Election Commission of India that came into effect on the 15th of last month, the water pipe-laying work which also began during the mid-week of last month on Gopalapuram Main Road in Gopalapuram, a neighbourhood in Avadi, has been kept on hold.

The work could have waited. It was commenced when we were all expecting the announcement of the election dates by the Election Commission of India sooner or later. Now with the road dug up, regular users find it quite difficult. It may be noted this road witnesses good traffic as it connects CTH Road, New Military Road and Thandurai Main Road.

This road was laid just six years ago and it was in a very good condi-



Gopalapuram Main Road in Pattabiram. The image was taken on April 18, 2026. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

tion. Instead of cutting the road, the pipes could have been laid along the parcels of government land that lie along both sides of the

road.

P. Arunkumar is the president of Gopalapuram Residents Welfare Association, Pattabiram

'Unsafe driving'



K.V. RAMESH

Without enclosing the load body, this lorry (as the image shows) loaded with mud and stones to its brink was seen driving on Poonamallee High Road on March 29, 2026 endangering the lives of other road users.

It must have crossed several junctions on the highway and how come the traffic police allowed it?

The Supreme Court of India has passed several orders aimed at proper covering of loads in trucks to prevent road accidents. But they are not being enforced.

K.V. Ramesh is a resident of Poonamallee High Road

Library reopened

The library which was functioning T.P. Chathiram Main Road near Shenoy Nagar has been reopened at T.P. Chathiram Ninth Cross Street a month ago.

According to officials, the library was earlier functioning from a decades-old building on T.P. Chathiram Main Road which was prone to flooding and infested with termites and silverfish resulting in destruction of books. As preserving the books was a challenge the library was closed five years ago and we were hunting for a place. Now, this new library has been set up at a land belonging to the Greater Chennai Corporation. The library has got 6,300 books and 800 members.



The library at T.P. Chathiram Ninth Cross Street near Shenoy Nagar.

Easy does it; just vote from home

Chennai resident Visalakshi Jambunathan suffered a stroke seven years ago. Despite that, she headed to the polling booth in previous elections. This time around, she decided to make it easy for herself by opting for home voting; and she found the process to be easier than she expected it to be

LIFFY THOMAS

They want to fulfill their duty. And they want to fulfill it from the safety of their home due to their fragile health and advanced age.

Voting for senior citizens above 85 years and for voters with disabilities that have expressed preference to vote from home commenced in all 16 Assembly constituencies in Chennai on April 16.

A team of six comprising a micro observer, two polling officials, a police officer, a videographer and a driver landed at 74-year-old Visalakshi Jambunathan's house at Kallukaran Street in Mylapore around 11 a.m. after a word from the Booth Level Officer.

While the former chemistry teacher from Vidya Mandir Senior Secondary School in Mylapore is happy to be the first in her family and friends circles to have voted from home, she was missing something. "We are so used to getting



A senior citizen from Royapuram Assembly constituency shows her inked finger and (below) V. Santhanam with polling officials.

PHOTOS : B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



our finger inked after voting, but here they took my signature as proof that I have voted and have scratched my name from the list," says Visalakshi.

Seven years ago, following a stroke, the teacher suffered disability in her left leg and since then she uses splint to walk.

"My handicap has not limited me where my routine is concerned. I still go about doing all my work. As this option was available,

Home voters in each constituency

Velachery
1,064

Thiyagarayanagar
1,005

Kolathur
906

Anna Nagar
855

Virugambakkam
745

Mylapore
725

Thousand Lights
657

Saidapet
531

Perambur
459

Villivakkam
430

Egmore
344

Chepauk-Thiruvallikeni
327

Figures of persons who will be voting under the category of senior citizens, absentee voters and persons with disabilities

former school teacher who has never missed voting.

Eighty-eight-year-old V. Santhanam is always on the go, taking up civic issues with elected representatives and officials.

"I can easily walk down to the booth but I wanted to experience the system and I have to commend how the Election Commission has organised this," says the social activist from Chromepet.

He is of the opinion that many senior citizens are not aware of the "vote from home" option and more awareness about it needs to be created.

Old age homes

At Vishranthi Old Age Home in Palavakkam, five residents availed this option. All of them are bed-ridden but had expressed interest in voting, so the management made all the necessary arrangements. At least six others will be going to the polling booths to cast their vote.

At Anandhanam Old Age Home in Ambattur, one of the first things the management wants the residents to do is update the address on their Aadhar card and other documents. This is helpful to avail various benefits offered by the government to senior citizens, and comes handy during election time. This time, 20 people exercised their vote.

According to a report in *The Hindu*, with 106 requests, Kolathur has the highest number of persons with disabilities who have availed themselves of the home voting facility in Chennai. Royapuram has the lowest, with just 14 home voters.

Run for ethical voting

Voters Association of India, in association with Election Commission of India, is organising a 'Mega Marathon' on April 19 at 5 a.m. to create awareness on 'Ethical Voting and 100% Voting'.

The event is open to all and the online link requires one to sign a declaration that no political party's flag, shirt, badge or any item that resembles any party will be used during the run.

In case you have not signed up for the run starting at Napier Bridge then show your support on 'register to pledge'. Visit <https://votersassociation.com/megamarathon/index.php>

Book for senior citizens released

A special gathering titled "Story of a Banyan Tree" was held on April 11 at the National Centre of Ageing (NCA) in Guindy.

V. S. Natarajan, a renowned geriatric physician and educationist, spoke about the evolution of geriatric medicine in India, tracing its beginning and steady growth year after year.

The event was presided over by S. Deepa, director of NCA. V. Kanagasabai, former head of the department at Madras Medical College and Research Institute, spoke in detail about how to care for the elderly and the importance of it. A Tamil book in the title of *Keezhe Vizhamal Nalamaai Vazhuvom* was also launched for senior ci-

tizens, with around 500 copies of the book donated to the NCA.

In his address, Dr. Natarajan shared that his journey in geriatric care began 46 years ago. He also expressed gratitude to Bangaru Adigalar, and professor Annamalai who guided him through this division of medicine.

Referring to the theme, he described the banyan tree's shade as a metaphor for the NCA which has been providing care and support to countless elderly individuals across the country.

Many senior citizens and medical professionals across the city attended the event.

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